

Word family: **tour / tours / toured / touring / tourist / tourism**

Base word: tour

Plural: tours

Past tense: toured

Past participle: toured

** -ing form:** touring

Related forms: tourist, tourism

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “We joined a short snorkeling **tour** near the coast...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **tour** means an **organized trip or visit in which people travel around a place or take part in an activity, often with a guide or planned route**.

繁體中文： **按預先安排的路線或活動進行的短途參觀、遊覽或體驗行程**

中文翻譯：

> “We joined a short snorkeling **tour** near the coast...”

「我們參加了一個近岸浮潛的短途**行程 / 導賞活動**.....」

Here:

snorkeling tour = 有安排、通常由導遊或活動公司帶領的浮潛行程

1. **tour = organized visit/trip around a place (遊覽 / 參觀) — 遊覽；導賞；參觀行程**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A planned visit or trip during which people are shown around a place or take part in a particular activity.

Practice 1 — Original

> “We joined a short snorkeling **tour** near the coast.”

「我們參加了一個近岸浮潛**行程 / 導賞活動**。」

Practice 2

> “We took a guided **tour** of the old city.”

「我們參加了一個舊城區的導賞**遊覽**。」

Practice 3

> “The museum offers a one-hour **tour**.”

「博物館提供一小時的**導賞參觀**。」

tour = 按安排好的路線、時間或活動內容進行的參觀 / 遊覽行程

Common:

- * guided tour
- * city tour
- * boat tour
- * snorkeling tour
- * museum tour

2. **tour** = journey through several places (巡遊 / 旅行) — 巡遊；周遊；巡迴旅行

A **tour** can also mean a journey in which someone visits several places in sequence.

Practice 4

> “They went on a **tour** of northern Italy.”

「他們到意大利北部作了一次**巡遊 / 周遊旅行**。」

Practice 5

> “The group completed a ten-day **tour** of the region.”

「這個團體完成了為期十天的地區**巡遊**。」

tour = 在一段時間內依次遊覽多個地方的旅程

This is close to Meaning 1, but broader in scale and not necessarily guided.

For strict counting, I would merge these under the broad **planned journey/visit through places** concept.

3. **tour = series of performances/events in different places (巡迴演出 / 巡演) — 巡演 ; 巡迴**

This is a major modern meaning.

Practice 6

> “The band is going on **tour** next month.”

「樂隊下個月會開始**巡迴演出**。」

Practice 7

> “The singer ended her world **tour** in Tokyo.”

「那位歌手在東京結束她的世界**巡演**。」

****tour = 表演者、球隊、講者等在多個地方依次舉行活動的一系列行程****

Common:

- * world tour
- * concert tour
- * speaking tour

This is distinct enough for learners to keep separately.

4. **tour = official visit/inspection (正式訪問 / 巡視) — 巡視 ; 視察 ; 參訪**

****Tour** can refer to an official journey through a place or series of locations.**

Practice 8

> “The manager gave us a **tour** of the factory.”

「經理帶我們**參觀 / 巡視**工廠。」

Practice 9

> “The delegation began a three-day **tour** of the facilities.”

「代表團開始為期三天的設施**參訪 / 巡視行程**。」

****tour = 為了解、檢查、介紹或訪問而按路線走訪一個或多個地方****

For core counting, I would normally merge this with Meaning 1.

5. ****tour = travel around a place (動詞) — 遊覽；周遊；參觀****

As a verb, ****tour**** means to travel around or visit a place or several places.

Practice 10

> “We ****toured**** the island by bus.”

「我們乘巴士****遊覽****了整個島。」

Practice 11

> “They spent two weeks ****touring**** Europe.”

「他們花了兩星期****周遊****歐洲。」

****tour a place = 到某地多處參觀、旅行或遊覽****

This is the main verb meaning.

6. ****tour = perform/travel professionally in different places (動詞) — 巡演；巡迴活動****

Practice 12

> “The band ****toured**** Asia last year.”

「樂隊去年在亞洲****巡演****。」

Practice 13

> “The show will ****tour**** internationally.”

「這個節目將在國際間****巡迴演出****。」

****tour = 為表演、演講或其他職業活動而在不同地方依次進行活動****

For core counting, I would keep this with the noun ****performance tour**** branch.

Related form: **tourist**

A **tourist** is a person who travels somewhere for leisure or sightseeing.

Practice 14

> “The beach attracts many **tourists**.”

「這個海灘吸引很多**遊客**。」

Practice 15

> “The town is popular with foreign **tourists**.”

「這個小鎮很受外國**遊客**歡迎。」

tourist = 為休閒、觀光或度假而前往某地的人

Related form: **tourism**

Tourism means the activity and industry connected with people travelling for leisure.

Practice 16

> “The island depends heavily on **tourism**.”

「這個島非常依賴**旅遊業**。」

Practice 17

> “Eco-**tourism** has grown in the region.”

「這個地區的生態**旅遊**有所增長。」

tourism = 人們為休閒、觀光等目的旅行的活動，以及相關產業

Important distinction: **tour vs trip**

trip

is the broad word for a journey away from home.

tour

usually suggests:

- * visiting several places;
- * sightseeing;
- * a planned route;
- * or an organized activity.

> “We took a trip to Okinawa.”

= 去沖繩旅行。

> “We joined a snorkeling tour.”

= 參加一個有安排的浮潛行程。

So your passage uses **tour**, not merely **trip**, because the snorkeling activity was organized.

Important distinction: **tour vs travel**

travel

is the broad activity of going from place to place.

tour

usually means a specific planned journey or sequence of visits.

> travel around Japan

broad.

> tour Japan

suggests visiting multiple places systematically.

Important distinction: **tour vs excursion**

excursion

usually means a short leisure trip, often lasting part of a day.

tour

can be short or long and often includes:

- * sightseeing;
- * guided visits;
- * an organized route.

A snorkeling tour may function like an excursion, but **tour** emphasizes the organized experience.

Important distinction: **tour vs guide**

tour

= the visit/journey itself.

guide

= the person who leads or explains it.

> guided tour

= 有導遊帶領的行程

So:

tour = 行程

guide = 導遊 / 帶領者

Important distinction: **tourist vs traveller**

tourist

specifically suggests leisure, sightseeing, or holiday travel.

traveller

is much broader and simply means someone who travels.

A business traveller is a traveller but not normally a tourist.

Countability note

****Tour**** is normally countable:

> a tour

> two tours

> several tours

But in the performance expression:

> ****on tour****

there is usually no article:

> “The band is on tour.”

= 樂隊正在巡演。

This is an important fixed construction.

Useful expression: ****go on a tour — 參加 / 進行遊覽****

Practice 18

> “We went on a walking ****tour**** of the city.”

「我們參加了一個城市步行****導賞團****。」

Practice 19

> “They went on a boat ****tour**** around the bay.”

「他們參加了一個海灣遊船****行程****。」

Useful expression: ****on tour — 正在巡演 / 巡迴****

Practice 20

> “The band is currently **on tour**.”

「樂隊目前正在**巡迴演出**。」

Practice 21

> “She spent six months **on tour**.”

「她花了六個月時間進行**巡演**。」

This belongs to the performance-tour sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **tour**
* **tours**
* **toured**
* **touring**
* **tourist**
* **tourism**

Useful constructions include:

* guided tour
* city tour
* snorkeling tour
* world tour
* on tour
* tour a country
* tourist attraction
* tourism industry

The Golden Manual says common domain uses and family forms should be checked while keeping overlapping visit/journey senses merged where the same underlying concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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tour — organized visit/journey	按安排好的路線、時間或活動內容進行的遊覽、參觀或體驗行程	
tour — journey through several places	在一段時間內依次遊覽多個地方的旅行；與 organized-journey 義相關	
tour — performances/events	表演者、球隊、講者等在不同地方依次舉行活動的一系列巡迴行程	
tour — verb, travel around	到某地多處參觀、周遊或遊覽	
tour — verb, perform around places	在多個地方依次巡演、演講或進行職業活動	
tourist	為休閒、觀光或度假而前往某地的人；遊客	
tourism	休閒觀光旅行的活動及相關產業；旅遊 / 旅遊業	

For your original sentence

> “We joined a short snorkeling ****tour**** near the coast...”

The exact meaning is:

****tour = 一個有安排、按特定活動和路線進行的短途體驗行程****

So:

> ****snorkeling tour****

= ****有安排的浮潛行程 / 浮潛導賞活動****

This is not simply:

> ****a trip****

because ****tour**** suggests an organized activity, often with a guide, operator, route, or schedule.

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****tour****:

1. ****an organized visit/journey around one or more places****
2. ****a series of performances, talks, or events in different places****
3. ****verb — travel/visit places in sequence****

I would merge formal inspection visits and multi-place sightseeing into #1, keep professional ****touring**** under #2, and treat ****tourist / tourism**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base-word count.